

Homewise VOC Interview Notes #3

Before the interview (screener, done async or in first 2 min)

- Have you hired a contractor (plumber, electrician, HVAC, roofer, handyman, remodeler, etc. all count!) before?

Yes, I've remodeled three bathrooms before.

- Roughly what did the project cost? (A range is fine. Ideally, we want a mix: small repairs, bigger projects)

About \$100,000.

- Do you own your home?

Yes.

Warm-up

1. Tell me a bit about your home — how long have you owned it, and how often do you find yourself needing to hire someone for projects or repairs?

When I first bought the house, I didn't like the bathroom layout, so I remodeled three bathrooms.

The Recent Experience

Anchor everything on one specific recent hire. Don't let them generalize.

2. Walk me through the **last time** you hired a contractor. Start from the moment you realized you needed one.

When I bought the house in 2019, I didn't like the bathroom layout.

3. How did you find them? What sources did you use? (Let them list — don't prompt.)

Through friends' recommendations and Yelp.

4. How did you decide which ones to contact? What made you rule some out?

I interviewed them and ruled out the ones that were too expensive.

5. How many quotes did you get? How did you compare them?

Two quotes. I compared based on price and previous customer reviews.

6. How did you know if the price was fair?

By comparing prices.

7. What did you do (if anything) to check if they were licensed, insured, or reputable?

I asked them for their license and insurance information.

8. Walk me through scheduling and the actual work — how did that go?

It mostly followed the schedule.

9. After the work was done, what happened with paperwork, receipts, warranties?

They provided all the paperwork, receipts, and warranties together.

If you find someone trustworthy, would you hire them again?

Yes.

Do you want to refer the contractor to someone else?

Yes, if the experience was good.

Pain Point

10. What was the **most frustrating part** of that whole experience?

Since it was my first time remodeling, I lacked experience. Unexpected issues often came up, I sometimes bought the wrong materials, the results weren't always ideal, and communication with the contractor wasn't smooth.

11. If you could change one thing about hiring a contractor, what would it be?

I would choose a full-service (labor + materials) contract, because in the end the contractor gave me a large number of receipts to reimburse, which caused serious budget overruns.

Current Workarounds & Prior Spending

12. Is there anything you do today to make hiring contractors easier — spreadsheets, apps, asking neighbors?

Ideally, there would be an app that keeps everything related to renovation in one place.

13. Have you ever paid for a service to help you find or vet contractors (Angi, Thumbtack, etc.)? What was that like?

No.

Wrap-up

14. Looking back on that whole experience — finding, hiring, and working with the contractor — how would you describe it in a few words?

Stressful, time-consuming, and full of uncertainty.

15. Is there anything about hiring contractors I didn't ask about that I should have?

You could ask more about how to control the budget and avoid unexpected costs, as well as how to improve communication and reduce misunderstandings during the process.

16. Do you know 1–2 other homeowners who've hired contractors recently who might be open to a similar chat?

Yes, I know a couple of friends who recently did home renovations and might be open to sharing their experiences.